Himachal & Spiti Valley Winter Trip

Detailed itinerary • 23 December 2026 – 3 January 2027

Route: Pune → Mumbai → Delhi → Shimla → Sangla → Kalpa → Tabo → Kaza → Langza → Kaza (New Year) → Kalpa → Kufri → Delhi → Pune

Trip at a glance

DATE	ROUTE / PLAN	MODE OF TRAVEL	OVERNIGHT STAY
23 Dec	Pune → Mumbai; board train 22917 BDTS–NZM at 12:45 PM	Local transport + train	Train
24 Dec	Arrive Hazrat Nizamuddin at 8:35 AM; rest; overnight bus to Shimla (confirm schedule)	Train + bus	Bus
25 Dec	Arrive Shimla; Mall Road, The Ridge, Christ Church if time permits	Bus + walking/local taxi	Shimla
26 Dec	Shimla → Narkanda → Rampur → Karcham → Sangla	Private cab	Sangla
27 Dec	Sangla; optional Chitkul only if open; continue to Kalpa	Private cab	Kalpa
28 Dec	Kalpa → Tabo → Kaza, only if road and daylight allow	Private cab	Kaza / safe en-route alternative
29 Dec	Kaza → Langza; Buddha statue and village if accessible	Local cab + walking	Langza
30 Dec	Langza → Kaza; local sightseeing/rest	Local cab + walking	Kaza
31 Dec	Kaza local day; New Year's Eve dinner/gathering if confirmed	Walking/local cab	Kaza
1 Jan	Kaza → Tabo/Nako → Kalpa, only if safe	Private cab	Kalpa / safe en-route alternative
2 Jan	Kalpa → Kufri via Kinnaur–Shimla corridor	Private cab	Kufri
3 Jan	Kufri → Delhi Airport; Delhi → Pune flight around 9 PM (verify ticket)	Private cab + flight	Flight

Detailed day-by-day schedule

Suggested time windows only—not confirmed transport schedules. Winter road conditions may cause major delays.

DATE	ROUTE	TIME & PLAN	MODE	STAY
23 Dec	Pune → Mumbai → Delhi	Morning: travel to Bandra Terminus with a buffer. 12:45 PM: board train 22917 BDTS–NZM SF Express.	Local transport + train	Train
24 Dec	Delhi arrival → Shimla bus	8:35 AM: stated arrival at Hazrat Nizamuddin. 9 AM–4 PM: rest and prepare. Evening: confirmed overnight bus to Shimla; verify boarding point.	Train + bus	Bus
25 Dec	Shimla	Morning: bus arrival (actual time varies), hotel check-in/luggage drop. Afternoon: Mall Road, The Ridge, Christ Church; Jakhoo Temple only if time/weather permit.	Walking/local taxi	Shimla

DATE	ROUTE	TIME & PLAN	MODE	STAY
26 Dec	Shimla → Sangla	Target 6–7 AM departure via Narkanda, Rampur and Karcham. Allow 8–10+ hours in winter; aim to arrive before dark.	Private cab	Sangla
27 Dec	Sangla → optional Chitkul → Kalpa	Morning: Sangla village/Baspa Valley. Chitkul only if confirmed open and safe. Continue via Karcham and Reckong Peo to Kalpa.	Private cab	Kalpa
28 Dec	Kalpa → Tabo → Kaza	Leave early after checking road status. Tabo stop only if time permits. If Kaza cannot be reached safely before dark, stop at safe accommodation en route.	Private cab	Kaza if safely reachable
29 Dec	Kaza → Langza	Confirm road access. Visit Langza village and Giant Buddha statue if accessible. Arrange heated homestay and meals beforehand.	Local cab + walking	Langza
30 Dec	Langza → Kaza	Return in the morning if road permits. Afternoon: rest, Kaza market/cafés if open, confirm New Year plans.	Local cab + walking	Kaza
31 Dec	Kaza — New Year's Eve	Local sightseeing only if accessible. Evening: pre-booked dinner/gathering if confirmed; do not assume a public town-wide event.	Walking/local cab	Kaza
1 Jan	Kaza → Tabo/Nako → Kalpa	Long return drive. Leave only if route is open and driver says safe. Take breaks; Kalpa arrival is not guaranteed.	Private cab	Kalpa if safe; otherwise en-route stay
2 Jan	Kalpa → Kufri	Target 6–7 AM departure via Reckong Peo, Karcham, Rampur/Narkanda and Shimla area. Allow 8–10+ hours; avoid night driving if possible.	Private cab	Kufri
3 Jan	Kufri → Delhi Airport → Pune	Target 5:00–5:30 AM departure for airport. Flight around 9 PM per plan; verify exact time/terminal. Same-day transfer is risky; Delhi on Jan 2 is safer.	Private cab + flight	Flight

Sightseeing places by stop

LOCATION	SUGGESTED SIGHTSEEING	WINTER NOTES
Delhi	India Gate, Connaught Place (if time permits)	Prioritise rest and bus schedule.
Shimla	Mall Road, The Ridge, Christ Church, Jakhoo Temple	Access and weather may affect plans.
Sangla	Sangla village, Baspa Valley, Kamru Fort if accessible	Confirm local access and daylight.
Chitkul	Village, Baspa River views, snowy landscapes	Optional; winter road closures possible.
Kalpa	Kinnaur Kailash views, village lanes, apple orchards (seasonal)	Views depend on weather.
Tabo	Tabo Monastery and village	Stop only if transfer route/daylight allows.
Nako	Nako Lake and village	Optional; access and conditions vary.
Kaza	Kaza market, Key Monastery, Kibber, nearby viewpoints	Nearby excursions only if roads are safe.
Langza	Giant Buddha statue, fossil village, panoramic views	Confirm overnight homestay and road access.
Kufri	Kufri Snow Point / Mahasu Peak area if open	Activities and access vary with snow.

Approximate distances and travel time

FROM → TO	DISTANCE (APPROX.)	WINTER PLANNING TIME	MODE
Pune → Mumbai	~150 km	3–4 hours (varies)	Train / road
Mumbai → Delhi	~1,380 km	Use booked train schedule	Train 22917
Delhi → Shimla	~350 km	8–10+ hours (varies)	Overnight bus
Shimla → Sangla	~220 km	8–10+ hours	Private cab
Sangla → Kalpa	~90 km	3–4+ hours	Private cab
Kalpa → Kaza via Tabo	~210 km	8–12+ hours; road-dependent	Private cab
Kaza → Langza	~14 km	1–2 hours; road-dependent	Local cab
Kaza → Kalpa via Tabo/Nako	~210 km	8–12+ hours; road-dependent	Private cab
Kalpa → Kufri	~205 km	8–10+ hours	Private cab
Kufri → Delhi Airport	~350–395 km	6–9+ hours before disruptions	Private cab
Delhi → Pune	Flight route	Check your ticket; approx. 2 hours	Flight

Bookings, packing and safety checklist

TOPIC	CHECKLIST
Transport	Confirm Pune–Mumbai connection, train, Delhi–Shimla bus, each cab segment and airport transfer. Use a driver experienced in winter mountain routes.
Accommodation	Confirm heating, blankets, hot water, meals and winter road access in Sangla, Kalpa, Kaza, Langza and Kufri. Specifically confirm Langza overnight.
Road status	Check with local authorities/driver every morning. Snow and ice can disrupt Sangla/Chitkul, Langza, Tabo–Kaza and Kaza–Kalpa travel.
Altitude & cold	Pack thermal layers, insulated jacket, gloves, warm socks, waterproof shoes, sun protection, personal medicines and a power bank. Stay hydrated and avoid overexertion.
Food & cash	Carry snacks, water and some cash. Remote winter services, restaurants and ATMs may be limited.
New Year in Kaza	Confirm the event directly, reserve in advance and arrange safe return to your accommodation.
Flight buffer	Kufri → Delhi on Jan 3 is a high-risk same-day road connection for a ~9 PM flight. Safer option: travel to Delhi on Jan 2 and stay near the airport.

Planning note: Times and distances are estimates, not live road or transport confirmations. Weather, daylight, snow, closures and local advisories take priority. Do not continue mountain driving when your driver or local authorities advise against it.